



UNIV 101: Introduction to the Gen Ed Experience

Welcome to UNIV 101: Introduction to the General Education Experience. That last word is critical: *Experience*. The General Education program at the University of Arizona is more than a series of classes you have to take. It is an experience that can greatly impact the rest of your academics, your career, and your life. This course is designed to give you an overview of what you can expect from the Gen Ed program so you can make the most of that experience.

Over the next 15 weeks, you'll read narratives and essays from people from across the University of Arizona - faculty and staff, students and alumni - to get a variety of perspectives on the topics we're covering. You'll engage in a significant amount of reflection - a practice that makes learning meaningful. You'll tell the story of the learning you've done up to this point in your life and begin to craft the remainder of that story.

Course Description

A 1-unit course designed to provide an introduction to and a foundation for the general education experience at the University of Arizona. This course should only be taken by students who began at UA in January 2022 or later.

Course Objectives

UNIV 101 gives you a foundation for your General Education experience at the University of Arizona. It is designed to provide you with an

understanding of the purpose and value of the General Education experience, its relationship to the rest of your undergraduate studies and your experience as a lifelong learner, as well as the university General Education requirements. The course will also introduce you to one of the means by which you will reflect upon and document your learning in all of your General Education courses: the Gen Ed ePortfolio.

Expected Learning Outcomes

In an ever-changing world, being able to approach complex issues and problems from an interdisciplinary perspective is essential. Your General Education experience has the potential to significantly impact how you approach the world, your specific field of study, your career, your problem-solving, and so much more. It is an integral part of your bachelor's degree studies and is interconnected to your major(s) and minor(s). As such, after successfully completing this course, you should expect to be able to:

- communicate the **purpose** of your general education (so you know why you are taking these courses);
- explain the **structure** of your general education (so you feel empowered to determine the direction of your coursework);
- identify the intrinsic and extrinsic **value** of your general education (so you can stay motivated as a learner);
- use an ePortfolio to document and reflect upon what you have learned to **make meaning** of your general education (so you can tell other people, like potential employers, the value of your General Education studies); and,
- reflect on the **interrelatedness** of your general education, academic major(s) and minor(s), academic behaviors, and general well-being (so you can approach your Bachelor's degree holistically).

Course Format

This is an in-person course with weekly meetings. In this course, you can expect to engage with a combination of readings, videos, and reflective writing. Class meetings will include presentation of information by the instructor but rely extensively on small and large group discussions. This class is what's called a "flipped classroom," since your homework for a given week is due *before* its corresponding class meeting, rather than after. You should come to class having completed all the homework for that week and be ready to discuss the material. You should plan to be actively engaged, as outlined in our [Classroom Participation Guidelines \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800113\]](#). As a 1- [unit \[Link: https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/credit-definitions\]](#) course, you can plan to spend at least 2 hours per week on this class in addition to our class meetings.

Course Communication

It is essential that you keep up-to-date with any course communications from me, as they may directly impact your success in the course. Any communications for the entire class will be posted in the Announcements section on the homepage of the course D2L site which you should check regularly throughout the week (if it will help you stay on top of updates, see instructions on D2L for customizing your notifications).

Individual communications will occur in two primary ways. First, when entering grades for your submitted work, I will often enter comments for you to read - either individual feedback for you or group feedback for the whole class. Be sure to click on the comments icon next to your published grade item to read my feedback. It is a reasonable expectation for you to have of me that I carefully review your assignments; likewise, it is a reasonable expectation for me to have that you carefully review the feedback I provide on your assignments.

Secondly, I may send you an email through the D2L system. These emails will go to your official UA email account. Email communications are an integral component of professional workspaces, so it is important to develop the habits now to check your email account regularly (once per day, at minimum). It is a reasonable expectation for you to have that I check my emails regularly and respond to your messages in a timely manner; likewise, it is a reasonable expectation for me to have that you do the same.

Basic Needs

It can be very difficult to work to your potential as a student while also struggling to meet your basic needs, like access to food and stable housing. If you or someone you know are struggling with these basic needs, please connect with the programs and services listed [here \[Link: https://asuatoday.arizona.edu/basic-needs\]](https://asuatoday.arizona.edu/basic-needs). If you have questions at all, do not hesitate to ask me.

Assignments

You will have a variety of assignments that you submit for this class. They are described briefly below with more thorough information in the Assignment Instructions and Rubrics module.

For all of these assignments, you should be submitting original work. Please be sure to familiarize yourself with the [UA Code of Academic Integrity \[Link: https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/policies/code-academic-integrity\]](https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/policies/code-academic-integrity). Submitting unoriginal work, including work generated using AI, is not permitted in this class.

Weekly Reflection Questions (Due most weeks)

As scholars in a bachelor's degree program, it is not sufficient to simply learn and reproduce information; you must be able to think about that information, integrate it into your previous learning, make meaning of it, and

be able to apply it. Reflection is a metacognitive (thinking about thinking) process that allows you to make meaning of information. This skill is something to be practiced, an opportunity you will get in this course and throughout your Gen Ed experience.

Most weeks you will be asked to respond to a series of reflection questions that will focus on your journey as a lifelong learner, specifics about the University of Arizona Gen Ed program, and topics of well-being and academic success. These may be submitted in writing or as a video (see additional instructions on D2L), but in either case all questions should be addressed each week. The majority of these reflection questions will relate to, and contribute to, two of your ePortfolio assignments for the class: the [Wonderosity Project \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800115\]](#) and the [Story of a Lifelong Learner \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800521\]](#). The more thorough your reflections are week-to-week, the easier it will be to complete those two larger assignments.

Because your responses to reflection questions will often be the basis for class discussion, reflection question responses are due by 11:59pm the night before our weekly class meeting each week. [Weekly Reflection Guidelines \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9781122\]](#) and a [rubric \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10962902\]](#) for how your reflections will be graded is available.

Attendance & Class Participation (Weekly)

Class attendance and participation are essential for your learning and intellectual growth, which are both active processes. Much of the learning in this in-person UNIV 101 class happens during interaction with your classmates. Sharing your thoughts, experiences, and previous learning are valuable perspectives for you and your classmates. When we all benefit

from each other's knowledge, our learning is greater than it can be on our own. Each class meeting, you can earn up to 10 points for your participation in the learning activities, which you earn by actively contributing to all parts of the class period. Information on how participation is evaluated is available [here \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800113\]](https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-participation-and-administrative-drop). Please note that if you are late or leave early, your participation grade for that day will reflect that.

Of course, life happens and there are times when students are unable to make it to class due to illness or other emergencies. Your two lowest participation grades from the semester will be dropped, meaning you can miss up to two classes without it affecting your grade. Students who miss more than two classes who have documented extenuating circumstances may request an alternate assignment to make up for missed class. It is your responsibility, though, to communicate with me to receive an alternate assignment.

Students not participating in class at the beginning of a term may be administratively dropped from the class by the instructor. For this course, students missing the first two class sessions may be administratively dropped at the instructor's discretion. In addition, students missing five class sessions by the end of the administrative drop period may be dropped from the course. The UA's policy concerning Class Attendance, Participation, and Administrative Drops is available [here \[Link: http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-participation-and-administrative-drop\]](http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-participation-and-administrative-drop).

Absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance or practice will be honored. See [policy \[Link: http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy\]](http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy) for more information. Absences preapproved by the UA Dean of Students (or dean's designee) will be honored. See [policy \[Link: http://policy.arizona.edu/employmenthuman-resources/attendance\]](http://policy.arizona.edu/employmenthuman-resources/attendance) for more information.

Gen Ed ePortfolio "About Me" (Due Week 8)

Throughout your General Education program, you will be using an ePortfolio to document, organize, and reflect upon your learning. Revising and refining this ePortfolio will be the focus of your UNIV 301 course. In UNIV 101, you will begin to create your Gen Ed ePortfolio and add your Wonderosity Project, at least one learning artifact, and your Story of a Lifelong Learner. In week 8, you will begin your ePortfolio by creating your About Me page.

Review the full [instructions \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9808598\]](#) and [rubric \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10962881\]](#).

The Wonderosity Project (Due Week 12)

A General Education has the potential to fundamentally enrich the quality of your learning. It also has the potential to become nothing more than a checklist of requirements if you do not take an active role in planning it out. In this class you will read about Wonder and Curiosity. The Wonderosity Project will utilize some of your reflection responses to help you explore how your interests relate to the available Gen Ed courses so that you can research and decide which of these courses you might want to take. This should be, of course, a living document that serves as a starting point as your interests and curiosities will evolve over time as you progress through the Gen Ed program. This is not an academic planning tool but can serve as a starting point for such discussions with your academic advisor. Review the

full [instructions \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800115\]](#) and [rubric \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10962876\]](#).

Learning Artifact (Due Week 14)

During the course of your Gen Ed program, you'll be completing signature assignments and other work that demonstrate your learning. In UNIV 301, you'll reflect back on all of the Gen Ed courses that you've taken by collecting and curating learning artifacts from your classes. In this class, you will get started on that process of collecting and curating by adding one learning artifact from another class and reflection to your ePortfolio.

Review the full [instructions \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10844652\]](#) and [rubric \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10962874\]](#).

Final Project: Story of a Lifelong Learner (Due one week after our last class)

Every person is a lifelong learner. You have been learning your entire life and will continue to do so. How you go about approaching your experience as a lifelong learner is up to you. This assignment will utilize some of your previous reflection responses to address three fundamental questions, each related to one of the units of the course:

- Where are you from?
- Where are you now?
- Where do you see yourself going?

You have two options for completing this project. One option is to write a narrative. The second option is to develop a visual narrative using Adobe Creative Cloud Express or PowerPoint and recording a narration of your story. Please be sure to review information about the fair and acceptable use of images if you select this option. Review the full [instructions \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-9800521\]](#) and [rubric \[Link:](#)

[/d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?](#)

[ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10962872\]](#).

Optional: Office Hours (Extra Credit)

In all of your classes - Gen Ed, major, minor, and elective - visiting your instructor during office hours can help your understanding of the material, boost your grade, and help you develop professional networking skills. It can also be unnerving. For this class, you can earn extra credit worth up to 2% of your final grade by visiting me during office hours to discuss your work in the class, your Gen Ed experience, or other topics of your choosing. See the [Extra Credit Assignment Instructions for more information. Review the full instructions \[Link: /d2l/common/dialogs/quickLink/quickLink.d2l?ou=1347110&type=content&rcode=Arizona-10955142\]](#).

Grades and Grading Policies

Grading Scale

This is a regularly graded course, meaning that you will earn either an A, B, C, D, or E and that final grade will be a part of your Grade Point Average (GPA) calculation. As described in the University Catalog, these grades mean:

- A: Excellent
- B: Good
- C: Satisfactory
- D: Poor
- E: Failure

The final grade you earn will be based on the following:

- A: 90%+
- B: 80%-89.99%
- C: 70%-79.99%
- D: 60%-69.99%

- E: <60%

Your assignments will be weighted in the following way:

- Class participation: 40% of final grade
- Weekly reflection responses: 20% of final grade
- Four Gen Ed ePortfolio Assignments: 40% of final grade
 - About Me page: 5% of final grade
 - The Wonderosity Project: 15% of final grade
 - Learning Artifact: 5% of final grade
 - Story of a Lifelong Learner: 15% of final grade

Late Assignments

Managing your time as a college student (and beyond) is something that contributes greatly to your success; it also can take some time to figure it out. For the first three weeks of the class, you will have a two-day grace period for your weekly reflections. During these three weeks, you may submit your reflection responses up to two days late without losing any points. However, because these reflections will be used in the class meetings, after the first three weeks, you will receive up to half credit for late reflections that are up to two days late. Reflections submitted more than two days late will earn no credit.

The ePortfolio About Me page, the Wonderosity Project, the Learning Artifact and the Story of a Lifelong Learner are due late enough in the term that you should be able to plan accordingly. As such, these assignments may not be submitted past the due date except in documented extenuating circumstances, which should be communicated with me before the assignment deadline whenever possible. If you need help planning out the work for these assignments, you can use that as a discussion topic during office hours with me (see extra credit assignment above). Additionally, **Peer Academic Coaching [Link: <https://thinktank.arizona.edu/academic-skills>]** is

available through Think Tank and can provide guidance for a number of academic skills topics like time management, note taking, and test taking.

Requests for incomplete (I) or withdrawal (W) must be made in accordance with University policies, which are available

at <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#incomplete> [Link: <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#incomplete>] and <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#Withdrawal> [Link: <http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/grades-and-grading-system#Withdrawal>] respectively.

